

# Fundamentals of ELT/ELL in the Moroccan Context

***Supervised by :***

*Prof. Nour-eddine LAOUNI*

***Group 1***

***Conducted by :***

Imad Baghlili

Hasna HIMMI

Mohammed TAMIMI

Nizar TOUIL

**CRMEF Meknes : 2025–2026**

# Outline

**Introduction**

**Historical Context of Curriculum Change**

**Approaches Used In ELT In Morocco**

**Analysis of ELT In Morocco**



# ELT VS ELL

**1**

## **ELT (English Language Teaching)**

Focuses on the instructor's role, methodologies, pedagogy curriculum design, and assessment used to teach English.

**2**

## **ELL (English Language Learning)**

Focuses on the learner's perspective, including acquisition processes, learning strategies, motivation, and the challenges learners face.

# WHY ENGLISH **IN MOROCCO**?

- **Economic Globalization**
- **Higher Education & Research**
- **Social & Cultural**
- **Diplomatic Stance**



# THE LINGUISTIC LANDSCAPE IN MOROCCO

- **Darija( Moroccan Arabic)**
- **Modern standard Arabic**
- **Amazigh(berber)**
- **French**
- **English**



# HISTORICAL REVOLUTION OF ELT IN MOROCCO

**Pre-Independence**

Mainly in  
private school

**Post-Independence**

English was  
a secondary  
foreign  
language

**The 2000s**

Expanded in  
Higher  
education

# STRUCTURE OF THE EDUCATION SYSTEM & ELT PLACEMENT

## Primary school

Historically there  
was no English

## Middle school

English is introduced as  
A mandatory subject for  
3rd year students.

## High school

English is mandatory for  
high school students (3yrs)

# THE "VISION 2030" STRATEGIC FRAMEWORK

1

## Early introduction

Generalizing English instruction  
starting in primary school

2

## ESP

Strengthening English in vocational training and  
scientific high school streams.

3

## Teacher training

Reforming the training centers to better  
equip English teachers.



# CHALLENGES IN THE MOROCCAN CONTEXT

**The French vs. English Debate**

**Large Class Sizes**

**Motivation & Resources**

**The Gap**



# HISTORICAL CONTEXT OF CURRICULUM CHANGE



# What is a Curriculum?

Curriculum refers to the planned and structured set of learning experiences, objectives, content, instructional methods, and assessment strategies designed to guide teaching and learning within an educational system.

# HISTORICAL CONTEXT OF CURRICULUM CHANGE

## 1. Post-Independence Period (1960s–1980s)

- Education focused on nation-building and identity
- Strong emphasis on Arabization, while foreign languages had a limited role
- Curriculum was content-based (focus on memorization and grammar)

## 2. Structural Reforms & Expansion (1990s)

- Growing awareness of globalization and economic needs
- English gained importance as an international language
- Beginning of curriculum reforms to improve quality and relevance



### 3. National Charter for Education and Training (1999)

A major turning point in Moroccan education is the shift from content-based to competency-based education to focus on:

- Communication skills
- Learner-centered teaching
- Integration of languages (including English)

## 4. Implementation of Competency-Based Approach in 2000s–2010s:

Curriculum was redesigned to develop:

- Communicative competence in English
- Real-life language use

Introduction of new textbooks and guidelines

Emphasis on:

- Skills (speaking, listening, reading, writing)
- Active learning

## 5. Recent Reforms (2015–Present)

Alignment with 21st-century skills:

- Critical thinking
- Creativity
- Digital literacy

Continuous updating of:

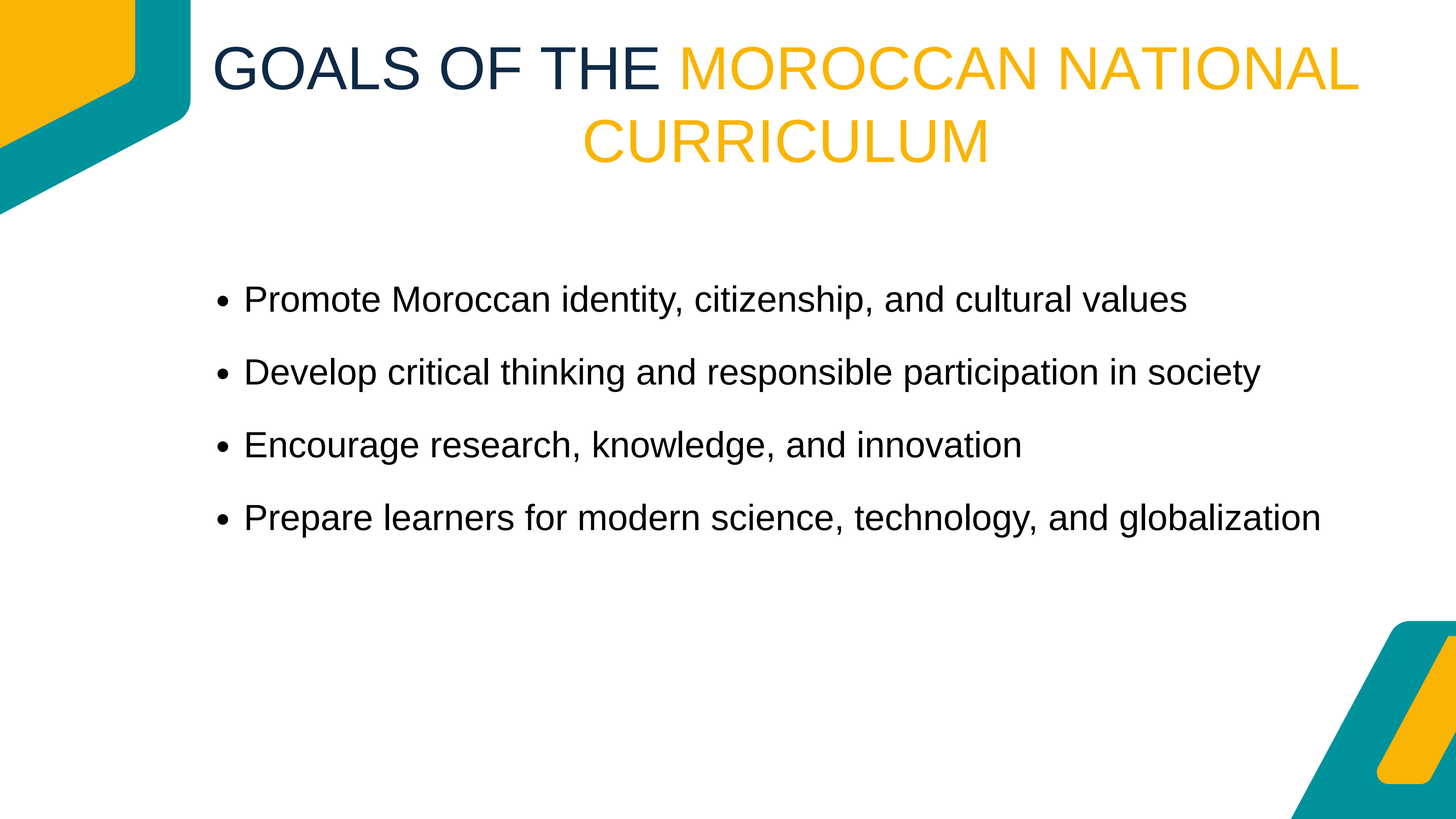
- Curriculum guidelines
- Textbooks



# STATEMENT OF VALUES AND AIMS OF THE CURRICULUM

The aims of the curriculum is in conformity with the four sets of values outlined in the National Charter for Education and Training:

1. the values of Islam
2. the values of the Moroccan identity, its cultural and ethical principles,
3. the values of citizenship
4. the values of human rights and their universal principles.



# GOALS OF THE MOROCCAN NATIONAL CURRICULUM

- Promote Moroccan identity, citizenship, and cultural values
- Develop critical thinking and responsible participation in society
- Encourage research, knowledge, and innovation
- Prepare learners for modern science, technology, and globalization



# GOALS OF THE MOROCCAN NATIONAL CURRICULUM

- to initiate them into citizenship and democratic practices;
  - to initiate them into negotiation, tolerance, and acceptance of different views as well as into modernity values;
  - to enable them to acquire the ability to communicate effectively in different settings
  - to develop their knowledge, understanding and appreciation of their own cultures and other people's cultures, and how these influence individuals and societies;
  - to raise their awareness of time as an asset both at school and in life
  - to help them develop their ability to think rationally and critically
- 



# AIMS OF THE ENGLISH CURRICULUM IN MOROCCAN SECONDARY EDUCATION

- Develop communicative competence in English
  - Improve the four skills: speaking, listening, reading, writing
  - Encourage learner autonomy and critical thinking
  - Promote intercultural communication
  - Prepare students for real-life use of English
- 

# AIMS OF THE ENGLISH CURRICULUM

1. To develop the communication competencies necessary for a variety of real-life purposes:

- Listen, understand and respond appropriately to others
- Speak effectively and participate in group discussions in different situations
- Read, understand and reflect critically upon what is read
- Write accurately and fluently Exchange information, ideas
- exchange information ,ideas, and experiences





## 2. To develop knowledge and sub-skills necessary for a variety of real-life: Purposes:

- to acquire a deep understanding of the language system
  - to understand and use the functions of language of everyday life
  - to express oneself using a range of vocabulary
  - to acquire semantic and discourse knowledge
  - to understand the way language adapts to context
- 

### 3. To develop study skills leading to learner autonomy:

- To work individually on assignments;
- to search out information for themselves from different sources appropriately and effectively
- to monitor and evaluate their own learning process in an appropriate way
- to develop their own independence in learning and using English
- to manage projects effectively

## 4. To develop the intellectual abilities of the learner

Helping the learneres

Develop high-thinking and meta-cognitive skills in the learnes such as:

- Critical thinking
- Logical reasoning
- Decision-making and problem solving
- Enquiry and evaluation skills

Elicit rules from language in use and discuss their hypotheses with others imaginatively.



## 5. To develop cross-cultural communication competency:

- to attain an understanding and appreciation of people's attitudes and values of other cultures
- to use their knowledge of the language creatively
- to consider other cultures and compare them to their own
- to develop an interest in cross-cultural aspects and other ways of doing things
- to convey their cultural concerns to other users of English.

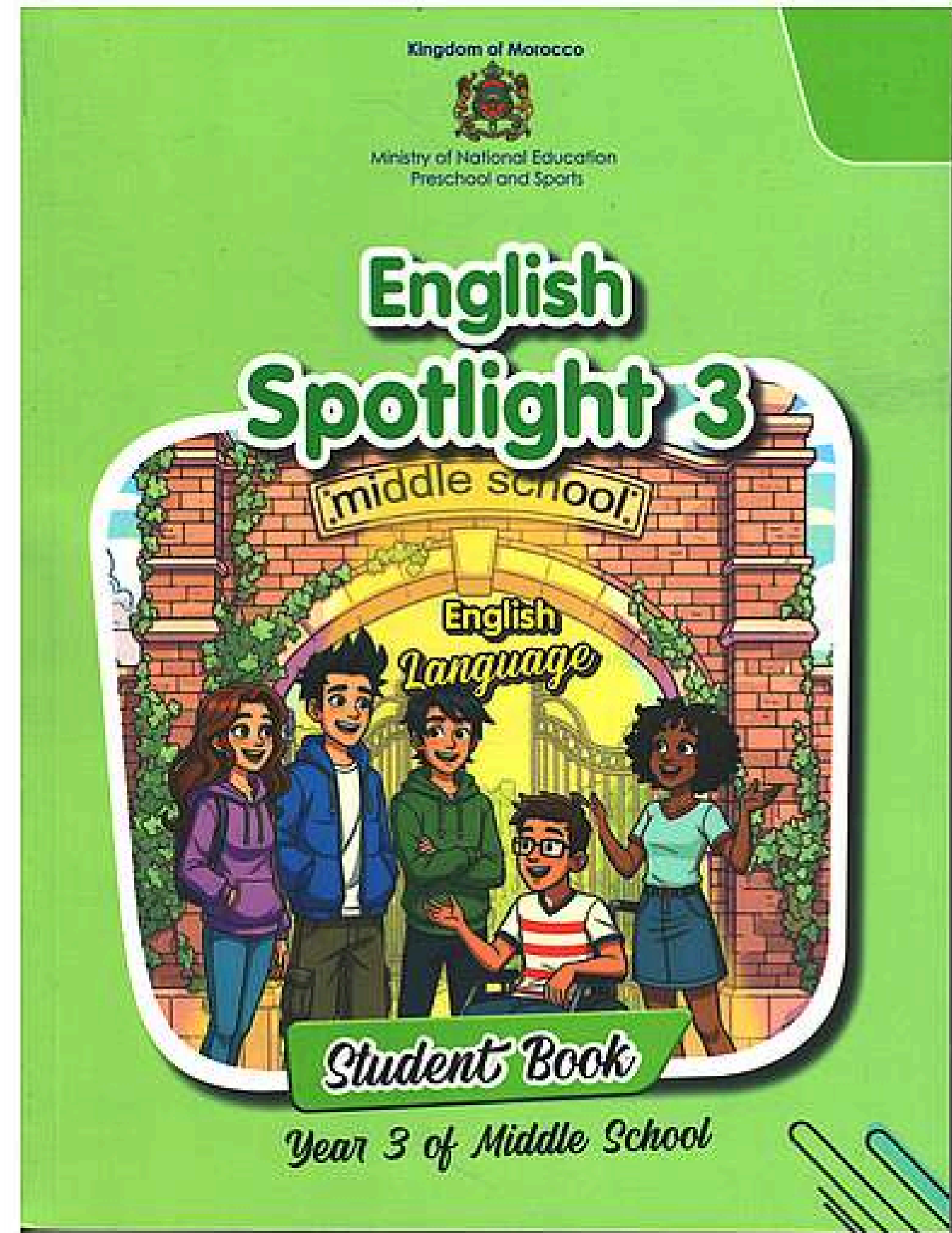
## 6. To enhance the learner's awareness of, and reflection upon, global issues:

- to get acquainted with, and reflect upon international issues and relations (eg, international organizations, world conflicts)
- to develop an understanding of economic issues (eg, business and financial news)
- to get acquainted with, and reflect upon, current issues (eg, human rights, women's rights, health, education, science and technology)

## 7. To reinforce values pertaining to character, civility, and citizenship

- to reflect on the consequences of their own actions and develop self-discipline, a sense of responsibility and self-respect
- to value cooperation and sharing respect and care for others
- to understand their rights and responsibilities as citizens and gain awareness of active contribution to democratic processes
- to value integrity, honesty and truth
- to respect nature and the environment

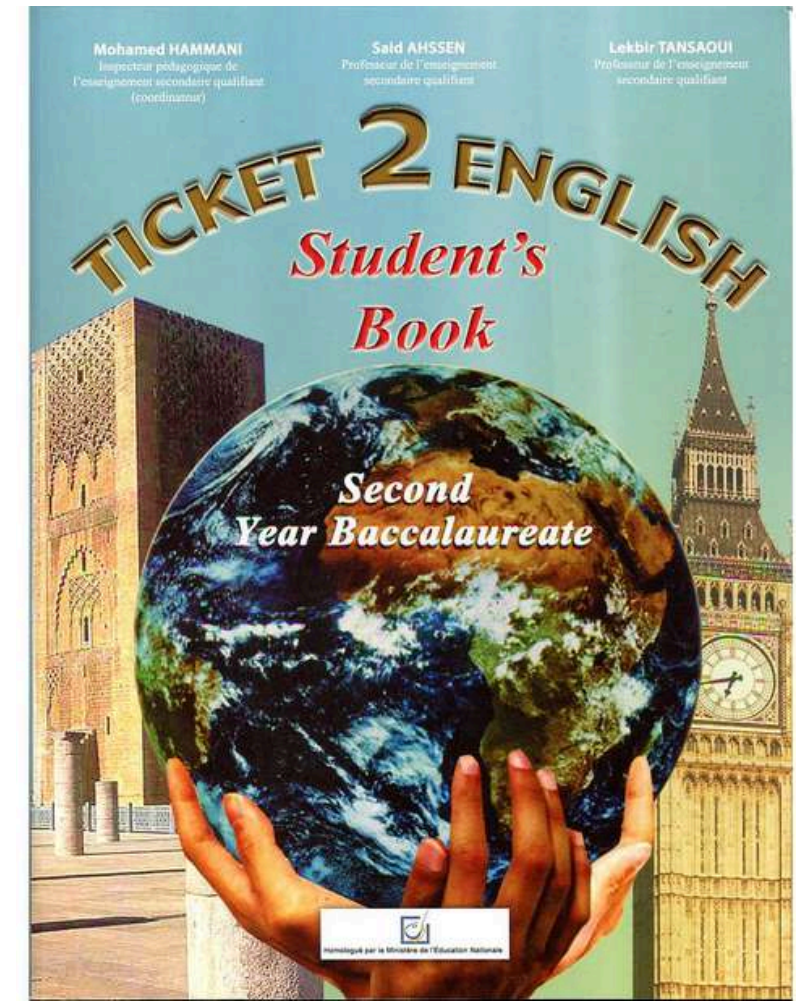
# INNOVATIONS IN CURRICULUM AND TEXTBOOKS DESIGN





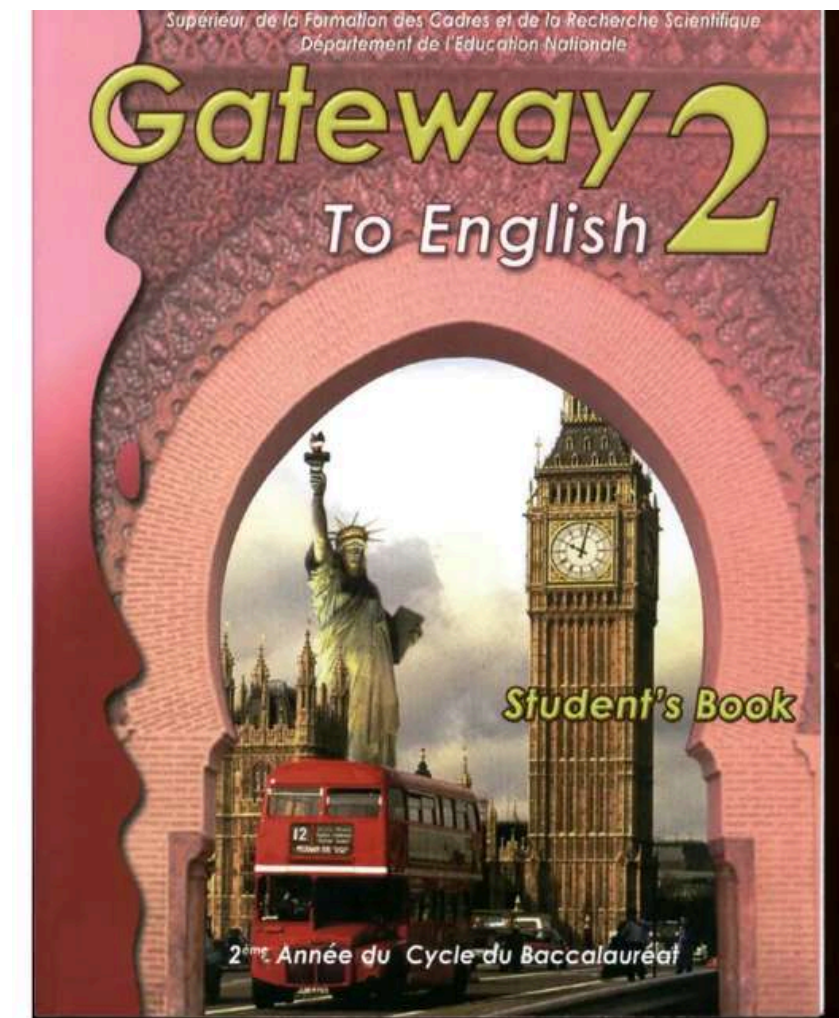
## Ticket to English

This textbook is dedicated to Baccalaureate levels, published in 2007 and edited in 2009, it offers students multiple activities that aim at developing their life skills in general and linguistic ones in particular.



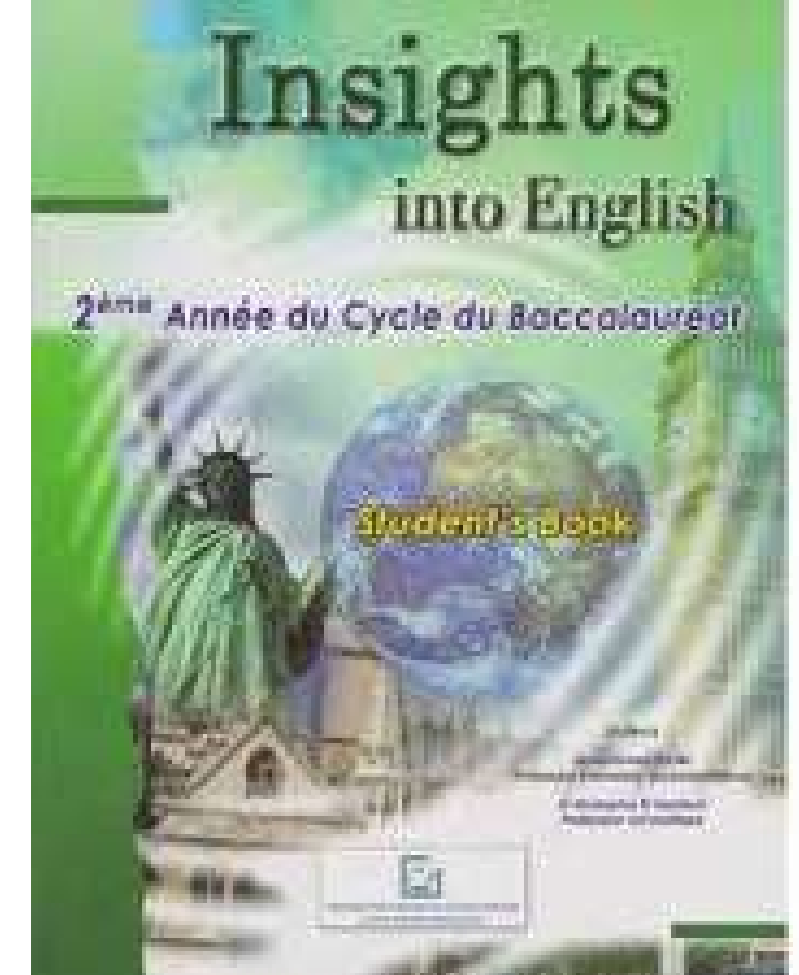
## Gateway to English

It is a textbook meant for the 1st year baccalaureate students in the public high schools of Morocco. It consists of 10 units that cover various themes and topics



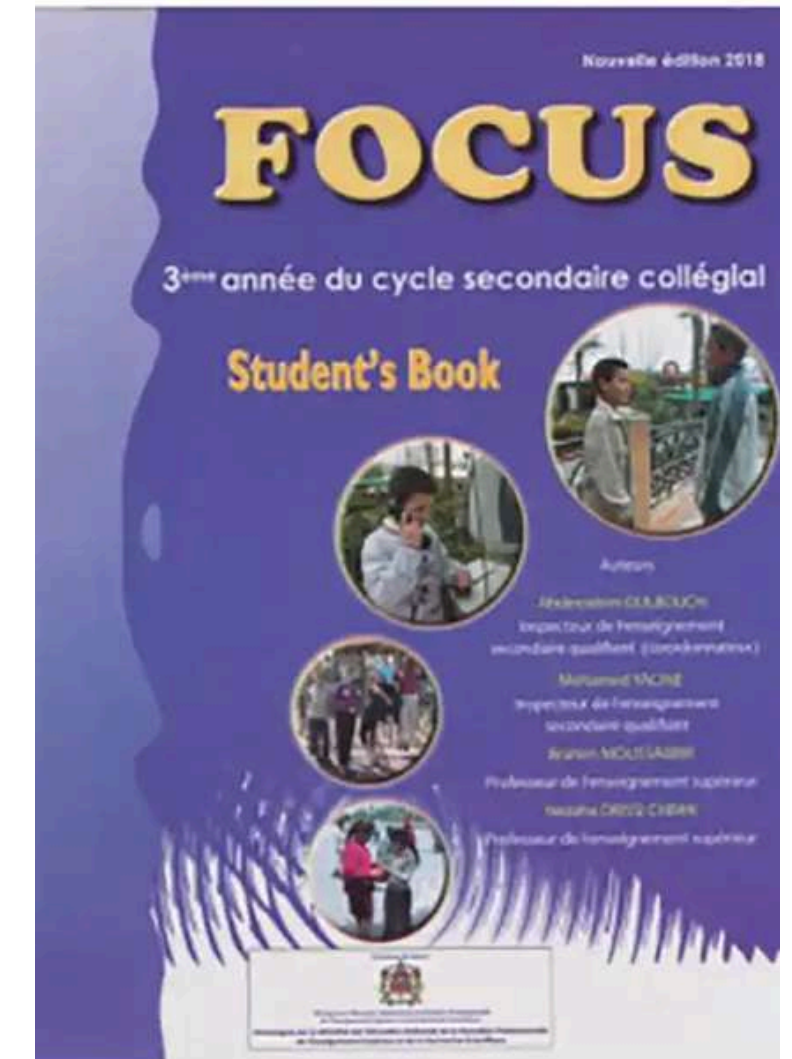
# Insights into English

The content of Insights into English is structured to guide the students on reading, writing, listening, and speaking abilities. It also includes exercises for self-assessment.



## Focus

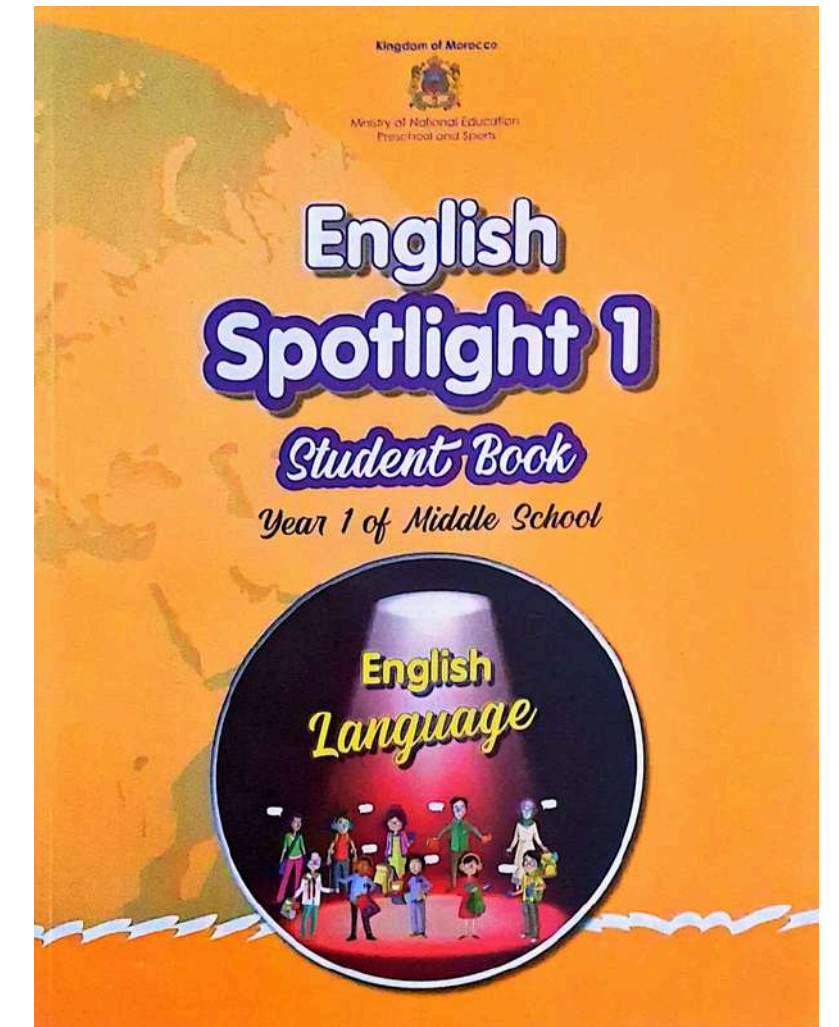
on is meant for 9 graders in the Moroccan context. The textbook was accused of being biased to some anonymous party as reported by Morocco World News on February 15, 2013.





## English Spotlight

As the Moroccan policy makers decided to populate English language teaching in the first and second year of middle school, a new textbook is out and ready for teachers to help their students approach English and broaden their horizons in a fun and engaging way.





# APPROACHES USED IN ELT IN MOROCCO





# DEFINITION OF APPROACH

An **approach** is a set of beliefs and theoretical principles about how languages are learned and how they should be taught.

It influences:

- Teaching methods
- Classroom interaction
- Material selection
- Assessment techniques



# COMMUNICATIVE APPROACH



# Theoretical Background

The communicative approach emerged as a reaction against traditional grammar-translation and audio-lingual methods which focused mainly on memorization and repetition.

**CLT** is based on the idea that:

- Language is primarily a **tool for communication**.
- Language is best learned through **meaningful use and interaction**.
- Learning occurs when students **use language in real-life situations**.

# Objectives

The main objective is to help learners **develop communicative and functional competencies**, including:

- **Grammatical competence**
- **Sociolinguistic competence**
- **Discourse competence**
- **Strategic competence**

# Key Principles

- Language learning is **interactive and social**
- **Fluency** is sometimes more important than accuracy
- Errors are seen as **natural part of learning**
- Real-life communication situations are simulated
- Students actively construct meaning



# Classroom Practices & Techniques

- Role plays and simulations
- Pair work and group work
- Problem-solving tasks
- Information gap activities
- Interviews and surveys
- Discussions and debates



# Role of Teaching Materials

- Authentic materials (pictures, videos, dialogues ...)
- Task-based activities
- Communicative tasks and activities
- Audio and visual resources

## Assessment

- Continuous assessment
- Performance-based assessment
- Oral presentations and projects
- Communicative tasks and role plays

# Role of the Teacher

- Facilitator of learning
- Organizer of communicative activities
- Motivator and guide
- Monitor and feedback provider

# Role of the Learner

- Active participant
- Risk taker in using language
- Collaborator with peers
- Negotiator of meaning
- Responsible for learning



# Advantages

- Improves speaking and listening skills
- Builds learners' confidence
- Encourages cooperation
- Makes learning meaningful and engaging

# Disadvantages

- Large class size limits interaction
- Limited exposure to English outside school
- Time constraints within the syllabus
- Neglected grammar accuracy



# STANDARDS-BASED APPROACH



# Theoretical Background

The Standards-Based Approach developed as part of modern educational reforms that emphasize clear learning standards and measurable outcomes. It focuses on defining:

- What students should know and do (**content standards**)
- How students achieve the targeted standards (**performance standards**)
- How well students should perform (**proficiency standards**)

CBA ensures alignment between **objectives, instruction, and assessment.**

This approach is influenced by educational frameworks such as the ***5 Cs standards*** (**Communication, Cultures, Connections, Comparisons, Communities**).

**CBA** is based on the idea that:

- Language learning should follow clear standards and performance expectations.
- Teaching and assessment should be aligned with specific learning outcomes.
- Students progress by demonstrating mastery of defined skills and competencies.

# Objectives

The main objective is to ensure that **learners achieve specific language standards and develop communicative abilities** through measurable outcomes, including:

- **Communication competence in real-life contexts**
- **Cultural awareness and understanding**
- **Ability to connect language learning with other subjects**
- **Development of analytical and comparative language skills**



# Key Principles

- Teaching is guided by measurable learning outcomes
- Objectives are clearly communicated to learners
- Lessons follow structured progression
- Assessment aligns with learning standards and performance tasks
- Language learning integrates communication, culture, and real-world use
- Students demonstrate learning through authentic tasks and practical application

# Classroom Practices & Techniques

- Task-based learning activities
- Project-based learning
- Pair work and group collaboration
- Problem-solving tasks
- Integrated skills activities (reading, writing, listening, speaking)
- Presentations and research projects
- Real-life communication tasks

# Role of Teaching Materials

- Authentic materials (articles, videos, real-life texts)
- Standards-aligned textbooks and resources
- Multimedia and digital learning tools
- Project and task-based materials
- Cross-curricular materials connecting language with other subjects



# Assessment

- Standards-based assessment
- Performance-based assessment
- Continuous assessment
- Portfolio assessment
- Self-assessment and peer assessment

# Role of the Teacher

- Facilitator of learning
- Planner of standards-aligned lessons
- Organizer of meaningful learning tasks
- Provider of feedback and support

# Role of the Learner

- Active participant
- Problem solver
- Collaborator with peers
- Critical thinker
- Independent learner

# Strengths

- Provides clear learning goals and expectations
- Develops communicative competence
- Promotes cultural awareness
- Connects English with other subjects
- Encourages learner autonomy and critical thinking

# Limitations

- Difficult to implement in large classes
- Requires well-trained teachers
- Assessment can be complex and time-consuming
- Limited resources in some schools



# COMPETENCY BASED APPROACH



# Theoretical Background

The Competency-Based Approach focuses on developing learners' ability to mobilize knowledge, skills, attitudes, and strategies to solve real-life situations.

**CBA** is based on the idea that:

- Learning should develop competencies applicable to real-life situations.
- Knowledge, skills, and attitudes are integrated and used together.
- Learning is student-centered and task-oriented.



# Objectives

The main objective is to help learners **develop communicative and functional competencies**, including:

- **Ability to use English in real-life situations**
- **Development of problem-solving skills**
- **Integration of knowledge, skills, and attitudes**
- **Promotion of autonomy and critical thinking**

# Key Principles

- Learning focuses on the **development of competencies**
- Knowledge is **applied in meaningful contexts**
- Learning is **learner-centered**
- Tasks simulate **real-life situations**
- Assessment focuses on **performance and ability to act**

# Classroom Practices & Techniques

- Task-based learning activities
- Problem-solving tasks
- Project-based learning
- Pair and group work
- Role plays and simulations
- Real-life communication activities
- Integrated skills activities





# Role of Teaching Materials

- Authentic materials (texts, videos, real-life documents)
- Task-based learning materials
- Multimedia and ICT resources
- Project and research materials
- Contextualized learning resources



# Assessment

- Competency-based assessment
- Performance-based assessment
- Continuous assessment
- Self-assessment and peer assessment

Assessment focuses on **learners' ability to perform tasks and demonstrate competencies.**

# Role of the Teacher

- Facilitator of learning
- Designer of real-life tasks
- Guide and mentor
- Evaluator of learners' competencies

# Role of the Learner

- Active participant
- Problem solver
- Collaborator with peers
- Critical thinker
- Independent learner

# Pros

- Develops practical language use
- Encourages learner autonomy
- Encourages active learning
- Connects learning with real-life situations and job markets
- Promotes critical thinking and problem solving

# Cons

- Difficult to implement in large classes
- Requires well-trained teachers
- Assessment can be complex and time-consuming
- Curriculum constraints may limit full implementation



# ANALYSIS OF ELT IN MOROCCO



# IMPACT OF ELT POLICIES ON TEACHERS



# IMPACT OF ELT POLICIES ON TEACHERS

Teachers are required to shift from traditional teaching to communicative teaching.

- Teachers are encouraged to implement communicative activities and learner-centered classrooms.
- Many teachers support Communicative Language Teaching (CLT).
- However, real classroom practice often differs from theory.



# Real world classroom situation:

- Large class sizes
- Lack of teaching resources
- Assessment system still focused on exams





# IMPACT ON STUDENTS

The curriculum tries to develop communication skills and autonomy.

Key points:

- Students are expected to participate actively in class discussions.
- ELT aims to develop communicative competence and real-life language use.
- Intercultural communication is increasingly important in ELT.

# STRENGTHS OF THE ELT SYSTEM IN MOROCCO

- Clear national curriculum.
- Integration of communicative teaching.
- Increasing attention to intercultural competence in English education.
- Teacher development initiatives supported by international organizations.

# LIMITATIONS AND CHALLENGES

- Gap between educational policy and classroom reality.
- Large classes reduce interaction.
- Limited classroom resources.
- Some textbooks do not fully support communicative competence  
(eg, Gateway to English 2, Insights into English 2, Ticket to English 2)

# Example 1 — Grammar-Focused Activities Instead of Communication

Typical situation in the textbooks:

Students are asked to:

- Fill in blanks with the correct verb tense.
- Transform sentences from active to passive.
- Complete isolated grammar drills.



Why this is a limitation

Communicative competence req

- Interaction
- Meaningful communication
- Real-life tasks

But grammar drills focus mainly on form rather than communication.

2. Choose the correct answer to fill in the blanks.

A. Gifted people are used \_\_\_\_\_ best in every competition.

- a. to score
- b. scoring
- c. to scoring

B. Some Moroccan youth associations recommend the government \_\_\_\_\_ an institute for talented students.

- a. to build
- b. build
- c. building



# Example 2 — Limited Real-Life Speaking Tasks

## Typical situation

- Some speaking activities are:
- Short controlled dialogues
- Role-play with fixed answers
- Reading scripted conversations

## CLT encourages:

- Open-ended communication
- Problem-solving tasks
- Authentic interaction

# Example 3 — Pragmatic and Cultural Communication Is Limited

Another issue identified by research:

Some textbooks include:

- Reading texts
- Vocabulary exercises

But fewer activities that teach:

- How to communicate in real-life situations
- Social and pragmatic language use

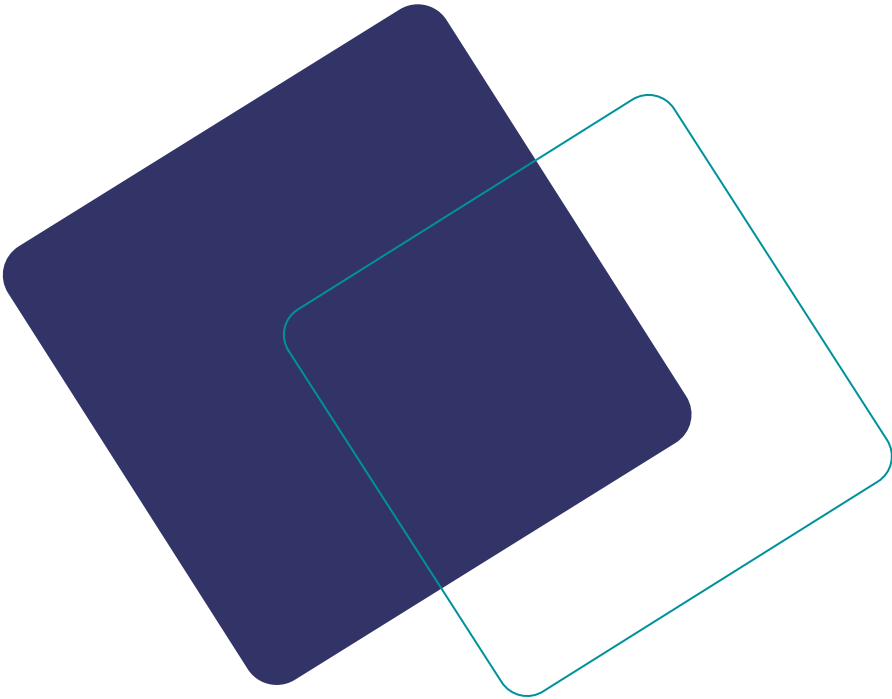
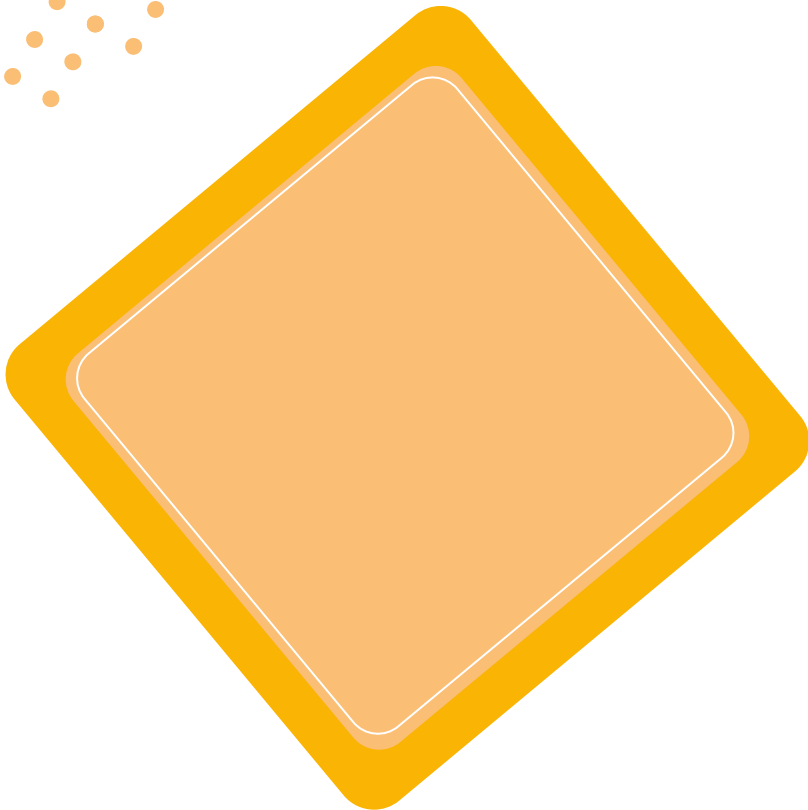
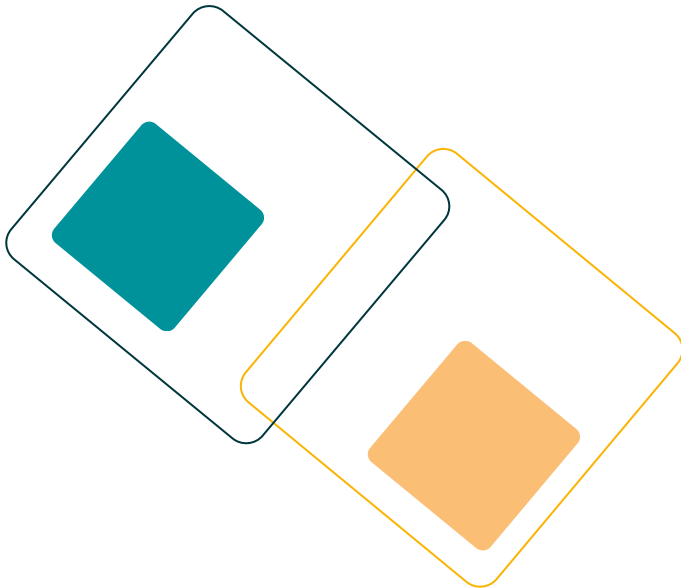
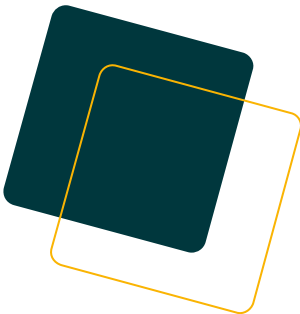
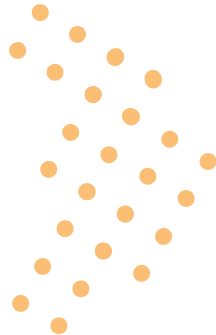
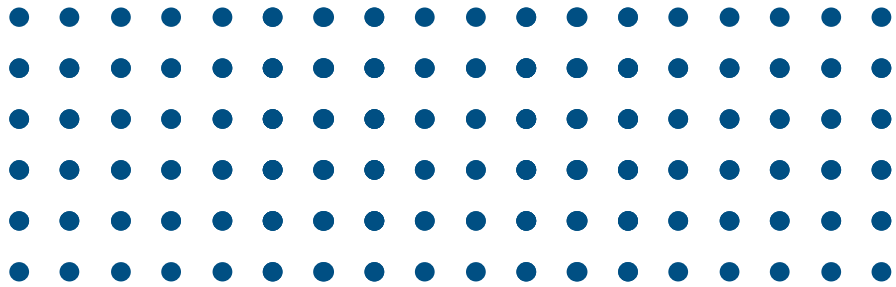


# CONCLUSION:

- Morocco is transitioning toward communicative and competency-based ELT.
- Progress exists, but implementation challenges remain.
- Future reforms should focus on teacher training, resources, and classroom conditions.



# THANKS FOR YOUR ATTENTION



# REFERENCES

Bouزيد, H. A. (2017).

Evaluation of selected Moroccan ELT textbooks from a standards-based approach perspective.

<https://ejournal.upi.edu/index.php/ijal/article/view/6879>

El Karfa, A. (2019).

Communicative language teaching in Moroccan secondary schools.

<https://journal.umy.ac.id/index.php/FTL/article/view/7770>

Ministry of National Education, Morocco. (2007).

English Language Guidelines for Secondary Schools.

National Charter for Education and Training (1999).

Morocco Education Reform Framework.